Events surrounding the B-59 have proved of greatest interest to historians. The submarine was spotted on 25 and 26 October and pursued by a task force led by the ASW carrier, USS *Randolph*. On the afternoon of 27 October, the destroyer USS *Beale* detected the B-59. After using its sonar, it began dropping practice depth charges. It was then joined by another destroyer, whose captain adopted the unauthorised procedure of using live hand grenades wrapped in toilet roll tubes. Martin Sherwin attributes this initiative to Captain Kelley of the USS *Blandy;* Serhii Plokhy states that hand grenades were dropped from the USS *Cony* (under Commander William Morgan). [45] These events, it should be noted, occurred a matter of hours after Major Anderson had been shot down and killed over Cuba, and as Black Saturday was getting darker.

Vadim Orlov's account of Captain Savitsky's outburst entered the lexicon of the crisis: 'We're gonna blast them now! We will die, but we will sink them all – we will not become the shame of the fleet.' Orlov recounts that Savitsky was then able to 'rein in his wrath,' and after 'consulting' Captain Arkhipov and the Deputy Political Officer, Ivan Maslennikov, decided to surface.[46] Again, these utterances are constructed from decades-long memories. The account also seems to imply that Savitsky's outburst and Arkhipov's intervention occurred as the depth charges were dropping and before the submarine surfaced.

When the B-59 did surface it was confronted by US warships. American accounts suggest there were courteous exchanges between the submarine and the USS *Cony*, before an ASW P2V Neptune aircraft arrived in the darkness and dropped incendiary devices to allow photographs to be taken.[47] The officers on the *Cony* believed the submarine saw this as a hostile act and maneuvered to aim its forward torpedoes.

A report from the Soviet Northern Fleet headquarters provides a rather different picture:

> When submarine "B-59" came up to the surface, airplanes and helicopters from the aircraft carrier "Randolph" flew over the submarine 12 times at the altitude of 20-100 meters. With every overflight they fired their aviation cannons. There were about 300